RULES GUIDEBOOK · 2 TO 6 STALLS · 45 TO 90 MINUTES



FRUIT MARKET

SET YOUR PRICE IN SECRET. SELL BEFORE THE FRUIT SPOILS.

GAME DESIGN BY MURSHIDI BIN MD HASHIM · TABLETOP RULES, RULES VERSION 18

THE BIG IDEA

Each player runs a small fruit stall. Each morning you buy fruit at the Wholesale Market. Each day you sell it to customers. Fruit ages every night, sells for less as it ages, and is then thrown away. The stall with the most cash at the end of the last day wins.

Three things pull against you every day:

1. **The clock.** Every night all fruit ages one step. Older fruit sells for less, and then it spoils.
2. **The secret price.** You never see a rival's prices until the bell. Price too high and the customer walks past you. Price too low and you give money away.
3. **The shut crate.** Stalls are secret. Before prices are set you learn only how many pieces each rival has in its crate, not which fruit.

WHAT IS NEW IN RULES VERSION 18

Out of cash. At dawn, from Day 2, a stall with an empty shelf and less than $5 is topped up to $5 by the bank.

Standing orders: a stake, not fines. The winner puts down the card's stake. It comes back for a full delivery and is lost otherwise. Only the winner's crate fills the order; rivals are not involved.

What a stall buys is seen while it buys. After buying it goes behind the shutter with the rest of the shelf: you need not say what you bought, and nobody may ask.

Favoured Trade is played after prices flip, by a stall with a tied price, in the open.

Days 1 and 2 have no mango customers, and Mango Craze is never Day 2's event.

Numbers. A green mango costs $4. Upgrades cost Juice Bar $6, Handcart $6, Premium Display $5, Ripening Room $4, Order Book $3. Nest Egg starts with $15. One favour deck of 12 at every table size. The three Bargain blueberry customers pay $4.

Rulings. A guest joins a full row. The final tie after cash and fruit sold is a shared win. Only one Priority card an evening; on Day 3 it goes ahead of Nest Egg. A Juice Bar's $1 is for customers and guests only. A Premium Display never raises a guest's price.

WHAT IS IN THE BOX

1 Wholesale Market board (three panels) · 6 stall sheets, 6 shutters and 6 counters (each counter carries a cash track) · 200 fruit pieces, 50 of each fruit · 24 price tags, four per stall · 12 cash markers, two per stall · 36 served-alone chips, six per stall · 36 customer cards and 5 guest cards · 20 event cards and 20 lorry cards · 12 favour cards · 30 upgrade cards, 6 of each · 8 standing-order cards · 8 shopkeeper cards · day marker, first-player token, Shade Cloth marker, six +$200 chips. You also need a dry-wipe pen or pencil for each stall.

THE FRUIT

Every fruit follows the same rule. A **Fresh** piece sells at the customer's top price. An **Okay** piece sells for $1 less. A **Soft** piece sells for $2 less. **Green** fruit cannot be sold until it ripens. A fruit's last two days are Okay, then Soft; every day before that is Fresh. Mangoes always arrive Green and spend 2 nights ripening first.

Each lane on the board, and on your stall sheet, is that fruit's life from right (newest) to left (oldest). Every night, every piece slides one box to the left. A piece that slides out of its Soft box is thrown away.

FRUIT	LASTS	ITS BOXES, OLDEST ON THE LEFT, WITH THE COST TO BUY FROM EACH
Blueberry	3 days	S $1 · O $1 · F $2
Watermelon	4 days	S $1 · O $2 · F $3 · F $3
Mango	5 days	S $1 · O $3 · F $6 · G $4 · G $4
Apple	6 days	S $1 · O $2 · F $3 · F $3 · F $3 · F $3

S = Soft, O = Okay, F = Fresh, G = Green. Every mango arrives green; no other fruit does.

CUSTOMERS

A customer card shows one or two fruits. For each one it shows how many they want (the circles) and the most they pay for a Fresh piece (the price tag). They pay $1 less for Okay and $2 less for Soft. The black band is the customer's freshness type: **Premium** buys Fresh fruit only; **Everyday** buys Fresh or Okay; **Bargain** buys Fresh, Okay or Soft.

The back of the card shows only which fruits they want. A face-down customer keeps their amounts, prices and type secret.

Each day brings one **regular** (drawn face up, a day ahead) and some **walk-ins** (drawn face down, a day ahead). The crowd is one customer per stall, and never more than 5: the regular plus one walk-in for every stall after the first, up to 4. With 6 stalls every customer wants one more of the first fruit on their card. Nobody waits overnight: a customer who does not get everything leaves. **On Day 1 and Day 2 no customer wants a mango** (a mango needs two nights to ripen): when you deal those two rows, a card that shows a mango goes to the bottom of the deck and you deal another.

SET-UP

1. **The board.** Open it in the middle of the table. Shuffle the 20 event cards and the 20 lorry cards and put each deck face down on its space. Put the day marker on 1. Agree the length: Quick is 8 days, Standard is 10, Long is 14.
2. **The supply.** Put all the fruit pieces in a pile within reach. The market starts empty.
3. **Each stall** takes a stall sheet, the shutter, the counter, cash markers and chips in the same pattern, four price tags and a pen. Stand the shutter in front of your sheet and lay the counter in front of the shutter: the shutter stays up all game. On your counter's cash track, put your Tens marker on 10 and your Ones marker on 0: you start with $10.
4. **First player.** Give the first-player token to a stall at random.
5. **Shopkeepers.** Lay the 8 shopkeeper cards face up. Starting with the player to the left of the token, each stall picks one. It gives you one perk for the whole game. Saleh moves his cash to $15. Ah Chen draws 3 favour cards once the deck is ready.
6. **Favour cards and upgrades.** Use 2 of each favour card (12 cards) at every table size. Shuffle them face down beside the board. Lay the upgrade cards face up in 5 piles. Shuffle the 8 standing-order cards face down beside them.
7. **Customers.** Shuffle the 36 customer cards. Keep the 5 guest cards to one side. Deal today's crowd in a row on the table: one regular face up, then one walk-in face down for every stall after the first, up to four. No mango customers on Day 1 or Day 2 (see Customers).

MONEY: THE CASH TRACK

Your cash is your Tens marker plus your Ones marker, on the cash track on your **counter**, in front of your shutter. With Tens on 10 and Ones on 4 you have $14. When you are paid or you pay, move the Ones marker, and carry to the Tens marker when you pass 9 or go below 0. If you pass $199, take a +$200 chip and start the Tens again from 0.

Cash is public. Everyone can read everyone's cash at any time. Nobody hands money to anybody: each stall moves its own markers while the table watches.

A DAY IN FIVE STEPS

1 MORNING

1. **Event.** From Day 2 onward, turn over the top event card onto "Today's event" and do what it says. Nobody knows an event before its own morning. There is no event on Day 1. If the event adds walk-ins, deal them face down at the end of today's row. If it removes walk-ins, the last ones in today's row go back under the customer deck. If it brings a guest, add that guest card to the end of the row. If Mango Craze turns up on Day 2, put it at the bottom of the deck and turn over another.
2. **Out of cash.** From Day 2: a stall with an empty shelf (no pieces at all, green ones included) and less than $5 is topped up to $5 by the bank. Do this after the event and any Health Inspector charge, before anyone bids or buys.
3. **The lorry.** The card on "Tomorrow's lorry" is now today's lorry (on Day 1, turn over the top card of the deck). Find the row for your number of stalls and take that many pieces of each fruit from the supply. Put them in that fruit's box marked "The lorry unloads here". Mangoes always arrive green and go in the far green box. The Seconds Lorry unloads its other fruit into each fruit's freshest Okay box. A Mango Windfall's extra mangoes are ripe: put them in the mango's Fresh box.
4. **Tomorrow.** Discard today's lorry card and turn the next one face up onto "Tomorrow's lorry". Then deal **tomorrow's row** below today's: one regular face up and the walk-ins face down (use the "Daily" number on the board). Tomorrow's own event may change that row tomorrow morning. Deal nothing for the day after the last day.
5. **On a Market Day.** Turn over a standing order and bid for it now, before anyone buys (see Standing orders).

2 BUYING

The poorest stall buys first, then the others follow clockwise from it. If stalls tie for poorest, the first of them clockwise from the first-player token goes first. On Day 1, start at the token. This is today's buying order; the evening and the last tie-break use it too.

On your turn, buy up to 4 pieces. For each one, take a piece from any market box, pay the cost printed on that box, and put the piece on your shelf row, in the box with the same position in that fruit's lane (same letter, same distance from the Soft end). Your sheet holds 8 pieces in all. You may play Free Fruit, Scout or Fridge on your turn. Buying is done in the open: everyone sees what you take while you buy. **After buying it goes behind your shutter** with the rest of your shelf, and nobody may ask what you bought.

3 STOCKING

1. **The crowd arrives.** Turn today's walk-ins face up. The row is always in this order, left to right: a standing order collected today, the regular, the walk-ins in the order they were drawn, then a guest. The regular, the walk-ins and a standing order never make more than five cards: a standing order takes the place of the last walk-in. A guest joins the end of the row even when it is full.
2. **Fill your crate.** Behind your shutter, slide each piece you want to sell today straight up, from the shelf row into the crate box above it. Any freshness may go in; green fruit may not. Pieces left on the shelf cannot be sold today, and they still get older tonight.
3. **Say how many.** When everyone is ready, each stall says how many pieces are in its crate, and nothing else. Which fruit, and how fresh, stays secret until the bell.

You may not ask what is behind a shutter, and nobody has to tell you.

4 THE BELL

Write one price on the tag of each fruit you have in your crate, and lay the tag face down. One price covers every piece of that fruit. There is no lowest price. When everyone is ready, flip all tags together and lay each one on its fruit on your counter. Then every crate comes out: move your crate pieces from behind the shutter onto your counter, each into the box with the same letter and place. Your shelf stays behind the shutter.

Favoured Trade. Once the tags are flipped, a stall that holds Favoured Trade and has a price tied with another stall's price for the same fruit may play it. Tied holders decide one at a time, in today's buying order, in the open: play it or keep it. It cannot be played before the flip.

Your price decides which of your pieces can sell to a customer. Take the customer's top price for today (the price on the card, plus or minus any event, plus $1 on the last day): priced **at the top price**, only a Fresh piece sells; **$1 under**, a Fresh or Okay piece sells; **$2 under, or less**, any piece sells; **over the top price**, nothing sells to that customer. The customer must also accept the freshness: a Premium customer never takes Okay or Soft fruit, however cheap.

5 THE RUSH

Serve the customers one at a time, left to right. The stall that bought last this morning is the crier: they read each customer aloud. For each fruit on the card:

1. The customer buys from the cheapest stall that has a piece they will take at that price.
2. That stall hands over the oldest piece on its counter that is fresh enough for its price, puts it on one of the card's circles, and adds its own price to its cash track.
3. If the customer still wants more, they carry on with the same stall, and then spill to the next cheapest stall, until the circles are full or nobody else can sell.

Tied prices are broken in this order: a stall that played Favoured Trade; then the stall whose piece is younger; then Rosa the Haggler; then whoever bought earlier this morning.

Serving alone. The first stall to sell to a customer puts one of its chips on the card. If a second stall sells to the same customer, the chip comes off. When the whole order is filled and a chip is still there, that stall served the customer alone: it draws a favour card (one a day at most, 2 for the Charmer, and never past a hand of 3, 4 for the Charmer).

After the last customer. Every customer leaves, served or not. Put any unsold counter pieces back behind the shutter, each in the same box of the shelf row, and wipe your tags.

EVENING AND NIGHT

Evening. In buying order, each stall may play evening favour cards (Priority, Gossip). Only one Priority card may be played each evening: a second one stays in its owner's hand. On the evening after a Market Day (days 3, 6, 9 and 12) each stall may also build **one upgrade** from the five piles: pay its cost and take the card. A stall has room for 2. Pak Din lays the Shade Cloth marker on one fruit lane of his sheet. Farah peeks at one of tomorrow's walk-ins.

Night. On the board, and behind every shutter, every piece slides one box to the left. Pieces that slide out of a Soft box go back to the supply. Tomorrow's row moves up to become today's. Then pass the first-player token one seat clockwise and move the day marker on.

MARKET DAYS, CLOSING DAY AND THE END

Market Days are days 3, 6, 9 and 12, but never the last day. They bring a standing order in the morning and an upgrade that evening. The lorry still comes. **Closing Day** is the last day. Every customer pays $1 more. After the rush, the jam maker buys every ripe piece left on every stall for $1 each. Green fruit is worth nothing. **The winner** is the stall with the most cash. Upgrades are worth nothing. If stalls tie, the one that sold more fruit wins. If they are still tied, they share the win.

STANDING ORDERS

A standing order is one big public order. It is turned over on a Market Day morning and collected 2 days later. It wants one fruit, Fresh or Okay: 3 pieces at 2 or 3 stalls, 4 at 4 stalls, 5 at 5 or 6 stalls. Do not turn one over if its due day would be after the last day.

1. **Bid, in the open.** Before anyone buys, each stall decides. To bid, write on a price tag the price per piece you would fill the order for (from $1 up to the price on the card) and lay it face down in front of your shutter. To pass, say "pass". Everyone can see who is bidding and who has passed; nobody sees a price. **You may change your mind** (swap your tag, take it back, or put one down after passing) for as long as any stall is still deciding. When the last stall decides, flip all tags together. The lowest bid wins. A tie goes to a stall with an Order Book, then to the stall that buys earlier today. If everyone passes, discard the card. You may only bid if you have the card's stake in cash (half, rounded down, with an Order Book); you may always pass.
2. **The stake.** The winner pays the stake at once and puts it on the card, with one of its chips.
3. **Get ready.** The winner has three buying turns (today, tomorrow and the due day) to have the pieces on its shelf.
4. **Collect.** On the due day the card stands at the front of the row and is served first, from the winner's crate only. It takes the winner's Fresh or Okay pieces of that fruit, freshest first, up to the number it wants, and pays the winner its bid for each ($2 more for each with an Order Book). Rivals' fruit is never taken and rivals are paid nothing. Anything the order did not get simply leaves.
5. **The stake comes back, or not.** If the winner delivered every piece, it takes its stake back at once. If not, the stake goes to the bank. There is no other fine.

ORDERS	FRUIT	HIGHEST BID ALLOWED	STAKE	STAKE WITH AN ORDER BOOK
The School Canteen, The Smoothie Stand	Blueberry	$9	$6	$3
The Beach Resort, The Company Picnic	Watermelon	$12	$8	$4
The Pie Factory, The Cider Press	Apple	$11	$7	$3
The Airline Caterer, The Royal Banquet	Mango	$18	$12	$6

A standing order draws no favour card and pays no tips (a Juice Bar adds nothing either), and no event or Closing Day changes what it pays. It is not used in the Basic game.

GUESTS

Five events bring a guest card. The guest joins the end of today's row and is served like any other customer. A guest joins even when the row is full. A guest's price is fixed: the event's own price change is not added to it, and a Premium Display does not raise it. Only Closing Day adds its $1.

GUEST	EVENT	WANTS
The Gym Club	Superfood Trend	2 blueberries at $8
The Influencer	Mango Craze	1 mango at $15
The Hotel Chef	Hotel Order	1 apple at $8, 1 watermelon at $8, 1 blueberry at $7
The Wedding Caterer	Kenduri	3 watermelons at $8
The Bakery	Bake-Off	2 apples at $7

HOW MANY WALK-INS

STALLS	REGULAR + WALK-INS	FESTIVAL	TOURIST BUS	MONSOON DOWNPOUR
2	1 + 1	+1	+2	−1
3	1 + 2	+1	+2	−1
4	1 + 3	+1 (row full)	+1 (row full)	−2
5	1 + 4	row full	row full	−2
6	1 + 4, each wanting 1 more	row full	row full	−2

Never more than four walk-ins, and never fewer than none. An event changes today's row only, on its own morning.

EVENT CARDS (20)

EVENT	WHAT IT DOES TODAY
Festival	Every customer pays $1 more for each piece. Add 1 walk-in (2 at 4 to 6 stalls). The row still holds 5 customers at most.
Superfood Trend	Customers pay $1 more for each blueberry. Guest: the Gym Club wants 2 blueberries, Fresh or Okay, top price $8.
Mango Craze	Customers pay $2 more for each mango. Guest: the Influencer wants 1 Fresh mango, top price $15.
Hotel Order	Guest: the Hotel Chef wants 1 apple ($8), 1 watermelon ($8) and 1 blueberry ($7), Fresh or Okay.
Heatwave	Customers pay $2 more for each watermelon. Tonight all fruit ages 2 steps.
Apple Blight	The lorry brings no apples. Customers pay $2 more for each apple.
Blueberry Glut	The lorry brings 1 extra blueberry for every 2 stalls (round up). Blueberries cost $1 less to buy (never below $1). Customers pay $1 less for each.
Good Harvest	The lorry brings 1 extra of each fruit for every 4 stalls (round up). Every customer pays $1 less for each piece.
Bad Harvest	The lorry brings half of each fruit (round up). Every customer pays $1 more for each piece.
Price Hike	Every piece at the Wholesale Market costs $1 more today.
Price Controls	Today no stall may set a price above the limit shown for each fruit. Blueberry $5, watermelon $7, apple $6, mango $10.
Health Inspector	Before buying, pay $2 for each Soft piece on your shelf (never more than your cash). Never on the last day.
Lorry Breakdown	No lorry today. Fruit already at the Wholesale Market stays.
Tourist Bus	Add 2 walk-ins (3 at 4 stalls, 4 at 5 or 6 stalls). The row still holds 5 customers at most.
Monsoon Downpour	Remove 1 walk-in (2 at 4 to 6 stalls). No fruit ages tonight, at the stalls or at the Wholesale Market.
Durian Season	Every piece at the Wholesale Market costs $1 less (never below $1). Every customer pays $1 less for each piece.
Kenduri	Guest: the Wedding Caterer wants 3 watermelons, Fresh or Okay, top price $8.
Mango Windfall	The lorry brings 1 extra ripe mango for every 2 stalls (round up). Customers pay $2 less for each mango.
Pasar Malam	After the rush, the night hawker buys 1 of each fruit left in every stall's crate for $3 each, any freshness.
Bake-Off	Customers pay $1 more for each apple. Guest: the Bakery wants 2 apples, Fresh or Okay, top price $7.

"Customers pay $1 more" raises every customer's top price. A Heatwave night slides every piece two boxes. After a Monsoon Downpour nothing slides at all. The Health Inspector charges for the Soft pieces on your sheet before anyone buys: count them yourself, behind your shutter, and pay.

FAVOUR CARDS

You earn a favour card by serving a customer's whole remaining order by yourself. Keep favour cards face down in front of you, so everyone can count them. Hold up to 3 (the Charmer 4). A played card goes to a discard pile; shuffle the pile into a new deck when the deck runs out.

FAVOUR	WHEN	EFFECT
Gossip	Evening	Look at all of tomorrow's walk-ins. Only you see them.
Free Fruit	Your buying turn	Take 1 piece from the Wholesale Market for free.
Priority	Evening	You buy first tomorrow. Only 1 Priority can be played each evening.
Scout	Your buying turn	Look at one of today's walk-ins. Everyone sees that you played it, not what you saw.
Favoured Trade	After prices flip	If one of your prices is tied, play this to win every tied price today.
Fridge	Your buying turn	Every ripe piece on your shelf becomes one step fresher. Green pieces do not change.

STALL UPGRADES

All five are on offer on the evening after each Market Day. Build one that evening at most. You can build each upgrade once, and a stall has room for 2.

UPGRADE	COST	EFFECT
Juice Bar	$6	+$1 for each Okay or Soft piece a customer buys from you. Each night up to 2 of your pieces that would spoil become juice: $2 each.
Handcart	$6	Buy up to 5 pieces a day. Your shelf holds 10.
Premium Display	$5	You may price a Fresh piece $1 above a customer's top price. A guest never pays more than its fixed price.
Ripening Room	$4	Your Green mangoes ripen in 1 night instead of 2.
Order Book	$3	You win tied bids for standing orders. Your stake is halved. A standing order pays you $2 more for each piece you deliver.

SHOPKEEPERS

No two stalls can be the same shopkeeper. Everyone can see your perk.

SHOPKEEPER	PERK	EFFECT
Rosa	Haggler	You win a tied price when your piece is as fresh as the rival's.
Uncle Benny	Big Basket	Buy 1 extra piece each day.
Ah Chen	Charmer	Start with 3 favour cards. Hold up to 4. Earn up to 2 a day.
Saleh	Nest Egg	Start with $15 instead of $10. Buy first on Day 3.
Raj	Bargain Hunter	Your first piece each day costs $1 less (never below $1).
Kiki	Tip Jar	A customer who leaves with their whole order tips you $1 if you sold them any of it, or $2 if you served them alone.
Pak Din	Shade Cloth	Each night, name 1 fruit. Your pieces of that fruit do not age tonight.
Farah	Sharp Ears	Each evening, look at one of tomorrow's walk-ins. Once a day, a walk-in you have seen tips you $2 when you sell to them ($1 at 2 stalls).

SMALL PRINT

WHEN A DECK RUNS OUT

Customers. Shuffle every customer card that is not on the table into a new deck. **Favour cards.** Shuffle the discard pile into a new deck; cards in hands stay there. **Events and lorries.** Shuffle all 20 again. **Fruit pieces.** If a pile ever runs out, use any stand-in.

REMINDERS PEOPLE ASK ABOUT

- The lorry comes every day, Market Days included, unless an event says otherwise.
- Only pieces in your crate can sell. Pieces on your shelf do not sell, and they still age tonight.
- You are paid your own price, not the customer's top price.
- You always hand over your oldest piece that is fresh enough for your price. You do not choose.
- A standing order takes pieces from its winner's crate only. Rivals are not involved.
- A Juice Bar's $1 is for Okay or Soft pieces sold to customers and guests in the rush: not for a standing order, the night hawker or the jam maker.
- On Day 3 a stall that played Priority buys first and Nest Egg second.
- Pasar Malam: after the last customer, the night hawker buys 1 of each fruit still in each stall's crate for $3, oldest piece first, any freshness.
- The Health Inspector never comes on the last day. If that card is drawn then, draw another.
- Scout: turn one face-down walk-in up for yourself only, look, and turn it back. Say aloud that you played it.

OTHER WAYS TO PLAY

OPTION	WHAT CHANGES
Basic game	No shopkeepers, favour cards, upgrades or standing orders: just buying, stocking and the bell. Good for a first game.
Fixed prices (beginner)	Ignore the prices on the cards. Every customer pays the same top price for a Fresh piece: blueberry $5, watermelon $7, apple $6, mango $11. Generous customers pay $2 more: numbers 6, 19 and 27.
No Market Days, or no Closing Day	Either can be switched off before you start.

The day on one line. Morning: event, top-up for a stall out of cash, lorry, tomorrow's lorry and tomorrow's customers, standing-order bids on a Market Day · Buying: poorest first, up to 4 · Stocking: fill the crate behind the shutter, say how many · The bell: one tag per fruit, flip together, crates out onto the counters, Favoured Trade for a tied price · The rush: cheapest stall first, oldest fresh-enough piece, served-alone chips · Evening: favours, upgrades · Night: everything slides one box left.

These tabletop rules are rules version 18, the same rules the Fruit Market app plays by. The table pieces (the three-panel board, the crate row above the shelf, the cash track on the counter, the shutter and price tags) are how those rules are run by hand.